



Feast9

Dental Practice Management System

User Manual

For the Doctor and Reception Staff
Complete Reference — September 2026

This manual is your complete reference for using Feast9. Written for everyday clinic use — no computer expertise needed. Every section explains what to do in plain language, step by step.

Contents

1. Getting started — first login
2. The Dashboard — your daily view
3. Registering a new patient
4. Opening a case for treatment
5. Recording a patient visit
6. Prescriptions
7. Recording payments
8. Consent forms (screen, paper, offline)
9. Follow-up & Next Action
10. Booking appointments
11. Reports — revenue and pending payments
12. Analytics — business trends
13. Data Rights (DPDP Act 2023)
14. Backups — protecting your data
15. Settings, Doctors, Case Types & Import
16. Common questions

1. Getting Started — First Login

Open the web address your technician gave you in any browser (Chrome, Safari, Firefox). You will see the login page.

■ **Very first time only:** You will see a 'Set up admin account' page. Fill in a username, a password, and a security question — this question is used to reset your password later without needing anyone's help.

Logging in:

- 1 Open your clinic's web address.
- 2 Type your **username** and **password**.
- 3 Click **Log In** — you land on the Dashboard.

■ **Forgot your password?** Click 'Forgot password?' on the login page. Answer your security question to set a new password. No email needed.

2. The Dashboard — Your Daily View

The Dashboard is the first page after login — your morning briefing. Check it every morning before the first patient arrives.

Summary tiles at the top:

- **Follow-ups Needing Attention** — total count of overdue and upcoming follow-ups combined, with a breakdown showing how many are overdue (■) and how many are due in the next 3 days (■).
- **Total Outstanding** — total amount unpaid across all active cases.
- **Active Cases** — number of treatment cases currently in progress.
- **Today's Appointments** — how many appointments are booked for today.

Follow-ups table — colour coded:

All follow-ups that need attention are shown in one single table, making it easy to see everything at a glance:

- ■ **Red rows** — follow-up date has already passed (overdue). These should be called or seen first.
- ■ **Amber rows** — follow-up is due within the next 3 days. Call these patients to confirm or book an appointment before the date arrives.

■ Overdue rows always appear above upcoming rows so the most urgent patients are always at the top.

Other widgets:

- **Today's Appointments** — who is coming in today, at what time, with which doctor. Includes a link to the full calendar.
- **Recently Updated Cases** — the cases your team worked on most recently, with outstanding balance shown.

3. Registering a New Patient

■ Patients → ■ New Patient

Every new patient is registered once. This collects their contact details, medical history, and agreement to the data privacy notice.

- 1 Click **Patients** in the top menu.
- 2 Click ■ **New Patient** (green button, top right).
- 3 Fill in **basic details**: full name, age, sex (Male or Female), mobile number, address.
- 4 **Medical History** — tick any conditions that apply. Leave unticked if none.
- 5 **Allergies** — tick any drug allergies. This is critical — it shows as a warning on every prescription.
- 6 For **female patients**: tick pregnancy/nursing if applicable — affects which medications are safe.
- 7 **Emergency Contact** — name and mobile of someone to call in an emergency.
- 8 If the patient is **under 18**: a Guardian section appears. Fill in the parent or guardian's name and mobile.
- 9 **Read the Data Privacy Notice** — required by law. Read it with the patient, then tick the box to confirm they agreed.
- 10 **Communications Consent** — tick only if the patient agrees to SMS/WhatsApp reminders. Leave unticked by default.
- 11 Click **Save Patient**.

■■ **Data Privacy Notice is required by law.** You cannot save a new patient without ticking this box. This is a requirement under the Digital Personal Data Protection Act 2023.

■ **Searching for an existing patient:** Click **Patients**, type the name or phone number in the search box, click their name. The patient list shows ■ if a follow-up is overdue or ■ if one is due in the next 3 days.

4. Opening a Case for Treatment

■ Patients → Patient Name → Treatment Cases → ■ New Case

A 'case' is one course of treatment — e.g. 'Root Canal Treatment' or 'Braces Phase 1'. A patient can have multiple cases. Each case tracks its own treatment history, payments, prescriptions, and consent form.

- 1 Open the patient's record and click ■ **New Case**.
- 2 Give the case a clear title — e.g. 'Upper Molar RCT'.
- 3 Select the **procedure(s)** from the list.
- 4 Choose the **doctor** handling this case.
- 5 Enter the **estimated total cost**.
- 6 Add a **next action note** if needed.
- 7 Click **Save Case**.

■■ **After saving a new case, you will see a reminder to collect consent.** Go to the Consent Forms section at the top of the case page and get the patient's signature before starting treatment. See Section 8.

■ **Closing a case:** When treatment is complete, click **Edit Case** and change Status from Active to Closed. Only close when treatment is genuinely finished — the system records the exact date you close it, and this is used in reports.

5. Recording a Patient Visit

■ Cases → Case Name → Visit Notes → ■ Add Visit Note

After every appointment, add a visit note to the case. This builds a complete timeline of what happened during treatment.

- 1 Open the case. The **Visit Notes** section is near the top.
- 2 The date is pre-filled as today — change it if needed.
- 3 Type what happened — e.g. 'Second sitting: cleaning done, next in 7 days.'
- 4 Click ■ **Add Visit Note**.

■ Be brief but specific. Note what was done, any observations, and the next step. Notes cannot be edited after saving — only deleted.

6. Prescriptions

■ Cases → Case Name → Prescriptions → ■ Add Prescription

When the doctor prescribes medication, add it here. The system shows an allergy warning if the patient has known drug allergies recorded.

- 1 Open the case. Scroll to **Prescriptions**.
- 2 The date is pre-filled as today.
- 3 Type the prescription — drug name, dose, frequency, duration. E.g. 'Amoxicillin 500mg TDS x5 days'.
- 4 Click ■ **Add Prescription**.
- 5 To print: click ■ **Print** next to the prescription.

■ **ALLERGY WARNING:** If a red box appears above the prescription form, the patient has a known drug allergy. Check it carefully before prescribing.

7. Recording Payments

■ Cases → Case Name → Payment Log → ■ Add Payment

Record each payment as it is received. The running balance updates automatically.

- 1 Open the case. Scroll to **Payment Log**.
- 2 Enter the **amount** received.
- 3 Check the **date** (pre-filled as today).
- 4 Select the **payment method** — Cash, Card, UPI, etc.
- 5 Add a short **note** if needed (e.g. 'Advance for crown').
- 6 Click ■ **Add Payment**.

■ **Cost revision:** If treatment scope changes, use **Cost History & Revisions** (at the bottom of the case) to update the total. Enter the new amount and the reason. Balance recalculates automatically.

8. Consent Forms

■ Cases → Case Name → Consent Forms

Every case needs a signed consent form before treatment begins. The system shows a red '■ No consent yet' badge on cases that don't have one. There are three ways to collect consent:

Option A — Sign on Screen

- 1 Open the case. Click **+ New Consent**.
- 2 Read the consent text with the patient — edit if needed.
- 3 Fill in the date and witness name (optional).
- 4 Patient signs directly on screen with finger or stylus.
- 5 Click **Save Consent**.

Option B — Print, Sign on Paper, Upload Scan

- 1 Click **Print Blank Form**. Print and give to patient to sign.
- 2 Photograph or scan the signed form.
- 3 Click **+ New Consent** → choose **Upload a signed copy**.
- 4 Upload the photo or scan. Click **Save Consent**.

Option C — Mark Paper Consent Collected (Offline)

If you already have a signed paper copy and don't need to upload a scan:

- 1 Scroll to **'Paper consent collected?'** in the Consent Forms section.
- 2 Fill in the date signed and a brief note.
- 3 Tick the confirmation checkbox to confirm the paper copy is filed.
- 4 Click **Mark Consent Collected Offline**.

■■ Offline consent means the system records that consent was obtained — but the actual signed paper must be kept safely in the patient's physical file. The system cannot hold the paper for you.

9. Follow-up & Next Action

■ Cases → Case Name → Follow-up & Next Action section

Each case has a follow-up date and next action note. These appear on the Dashboard so nothing slips through. You can update them directly on the case page — no need to go into Edit Case.

- 1 Open the case. Scroll to the **Follow-up & Next Action** section (just above Cost History).
- 2 Change the **Follow-up Date** and **Next Action Note**.
- 3 Click **Save Follow-up**.
- 4 To confirm a time slot: click ■ **Book Appointment** — the appointment date will be pre-filled with the follow-up date.

■ **Follow-up date vs Appointment:** A follow-up date is a reminder to yourself. It appears on the Dashboard under 'Upcoming' or 'Overdue' but is NOT a confirmed booking in the calendar. Use ■ Book Appointment to create an actual time slot with the patient.

Follow-up status icons on the patient list:

- ■ Red dot next to a patient's name — their follow-up date is overdue.
- ■ Amber dot — follow-up is due within the next 3 days.
- No dot — no follow-up pending, or the case is closed.

10. Booking Appointments

■ Appointments

The Appointments section has a monthly calendar and a daily view. Each doctor's appointments appear in a different colour.

Booking a new appointment:

- 1 Click **Appointments** in the top menu.
- 2 Click **New Appointment** or any empty slot on the calendar.
- 3 Select the patient, doctor, date, time, and reason.
- 4 Click **Save Appointment**.

■ **Shortcut from case page:** Click ■ **Book Appointment** on the case page — the patient is pre-filled and the date defaults to the follow-up date you set, which you can then adjust.

Appointment statuses:

- **Scheduled** — booked, not yet attended.
- **Completed** — patient attended.
- **Cancelled** — appointment cancelled.
- **No-show** — patient did not attend.

■ Always update the appointment status after each visit to keep the calendar accurate.

11. Reports — Revenue and Pending Payments

■ Reports

Reports is your operational financial view — what was collected and what is still outstanding. Use the date filter to select a period, or click **This Month / This Year**.

- **Revenue Collected** — total payments received in the selected period.
- **Cases Closed** — cases the doctor explicitly marked as Closed (not based on appointments).
- **Revenue Overview (All Time)** — total billed, total collected, total pending, and collection rate.
- **Pending Payments by Patient & Case** — every case with an outstanding balance, largest first. Amber rows have overdue follow-up dates.
- **Payments Received in Period** — detailed payment list for the date range.
- **Cases Closed in Period** — list of cases marked closed.

Download options:

- ■ **Print Report** — PDF of the period summary. Share with an accountant or file for records.
- ■ **Download Pending (Excel)** — colour-coded spreadsheet of all outstanding balances with a Revenue Summary sheet. Download this weekly and save it somewhere safe.

■ Download the Pending Excel file regularly. It works completely offline and is your 'Plan B' if the system is ever unavailable.

12. Analytics — Business Trends

■ Analytics

Analytics is for stepping back and looking at patterns — use it monthly or quarterly, not daily. Use the year selector at the top right to compare years.

- **Monthly Trend** — new patients and revenue collected per month.
- **Busiest Days of the Week** — which days have the most appointments. Useful for staffing decisions.
- **Patient Demographics** — Men, Women, Children breakdown. Guides service planning.
- **Top Procedures (Year)** — which treatments are most in demand.
- **Monthly Case Type Trend** — how procedure demand shifts across the year. Spot seasonal patterns.
- **Revenue by Procedure** — which treatments generate the most revenue. Useful for pricing.
- **Doctor Performance** — cases handled and revenue billed per doctor.
- **Payment Method Mix** — Cash, UPI, Card split. Useful for deciding on a card terminal.

13. Data Rights (DPDP Act 2023)

■ Patient Record → ■ Data Rights

Under the Digital Personal Data Protection Act 2023, patients can ask what data you hold, correct it, have it deleted, or withdraw their consent for communications. The Data Rights section helps you manage these requests properly.

Logging a request:

- 1 Open the patient's record.
 - 2 Click the ■ **Data Rights** button.
 - 3 Select the type: Access, Correction, Erasure, or Withdraw Consent.
 - 4 Add notes about what the patient asked for.
 - 5 Click **Log Request**. A 90-day deadline is set automatically.
- **Access** — patient wants a copy of all data. Click 'Generate Data Export PDF' and give it to them.
 - **Correction** — patient wants information corrected. Edit their record, then mark the request as Completed.
 - **Erasure** — patient wants personal data deleted. System removes name, contact, address, and medical history but keeps clinical/payment records as required by law. **This cannot be undone.**
 - **Withdraw Consent** — patient no longer wants SMS/WhatsApp messages. One click turns off communications consent.

■■ All Data Rights requests must be resolved within **90 days** by law. Overdue requests appear in red on the Data Rights page.

14. Backups — Protecting Your Data

The system saves an automatic backup every day. However, a backup on the same server is not enough — you need an off-server copy too.

Quick backup — from anywhere:

Click the ■ **Backup** link in the top navigation bar. A backup file will download to your device immediately.

Full backup options — from Settings:

- 1 Click **Settings** in the top menu, scroll to **Backups**.
- 2 Click ■ **Download Backup Now** for a full database backup.
- 3 Save the file on your personal laptop, USB drive, or Google Drive.
- 4 Also click **Export to Excel (Plan B)** occasionally — this creates a spreadsheet readable in Excel or Google Sheets even if the system is completely unavailable.

■ **If something goes wrong** and data appears lost or corrupted, contact your technical support person immediately. Do not try to fix it yourself. Report the date and what you noticed — the sooner it is reported, the easier the recovery.

15. Settings, Doctors, Case Types & Import

■ Settings

Settings is where you configure the clinic and manage administrative functions. The top of the Settings page has three admin cards:

- ■■■■ **Doctors** — add, edit, or deactivate doctors. Each doctor gets a colour on the appointments calendar.
- ■ **Case Types** — manage the standard list of dental procedures. Add anything specific to your practice.
- ■ **Import Data** — bulk import historic patient records from an Excel spreadsheet. Download the template, fill it in, and upload. Preview shown before anything is saved.

Other settings:

- **Clinic Details** — name, address, phone. These appear on every printed prescription and PDF.
- **Clinic Logo** — upload your logo. It appears in the menu bar and on all printed documents.
- **Change Password** — update your login password.
- **Security Question** — update the question used for self-service password recovery.
- **Backups** — download database backup or Excel Plan B export.

16. Common Questions

Q: I can't log in — what do I do?

A: Click 'Forgot password?' on the login page. Answer your security question. If you also forgot that, contact your technical support person — they have a tool to reset it directly.

Q: What is the difference between a follow-up date and an appointment?

A: A follow-up date is a reminder to yourself — it appears on the Dashboard under Upcoming or Overdue, but is not a confirmed booking. Use ■ Book Appointment (on the case page) to create an actual time slot in the calendar.

Q: What do the ■ and ■ dots next to patient names mean?

A: ■ means a follow-up date is overdue (has already passed). ■ means a follow-up is due within the next 3 days. No dot means no follow-up is pending or the case is closed.

Q: Can I edit a visit note after saving?

A: No — visit notes cannot be edited once saved, only deleted. If you need to add something, add a new note for the same date.

Q: I entered the wrong payment amount. How do I fix it?

A: Click 'Remove' next to the wrong entry, then add the correct one. The balance updates automatically.

Q: How do I close a case?

A: Open the case, click Edit Case, change Status from Active to Closed. Only do this when treatment is genuinely complete.

Q: A patient wants to know what data I hold about them.

A: Open their record, click ■ Data Rights, log an 'Access' request, then click 'Generate Data Export PDF' and give it to the patient.

Q: The patient's name shows as [Anonymised]. What happened?

A: Their personal data was erased following a request under the DPDP Act. Clinical and payment records are preserved as required by law.

Q: How do I add a new doctor?

A: Go to Settings → click Manage Doctors → fill in their name → Save. They will appear in the doctor dropdowns for cases and appointments.

Q: Can two staff members use the system at the same time?

A: Yes. The system works in a browser and multiple people can use it simultaneously on different devices.

Q: How do I print a prescription?

A: Open the case, go to Prescriptions, click the ■ Print button next to the prescription. A PDF opens — print from there.

Q: How do I import old patient records?

A: Go to Settings → Import Data. Download the template, fill it in, and upload. A preview is shown before anything is saved.

